

International Regulatory Affairs

Science

May, 2026

International Regulatory Affairs (A01062)

Short Title:	Intl. Regulatory Affairs	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Science	
Cluster	Quality, Regulatory and Compliance	
Author	MKINSELLA	
Credits	10	Level: Postgraduate

Description of Module / Aims

This module will provide the student with an advanced understanding of the procedures involved in the regulation of pharmaceutical products and medical devices in the European Union, US and other markets. The structure and role of US, European and other regulatory authorities will be studied. Harmonisation of standards in the pharmaceutical industry and the various licensing routes for drug products in the EU will also be objectives of the module. The learner will be exposed to the interface between regulatory affairs and operations. Pharmacovigilance and the pharmaceutical inspection convention will also be emphasised throughout the course of the module.

Programmes

INTR-0017	Certificate in International Regulatory Affairs (WD_SINTR_MA)	5 / 0 / M
INTR-0017	MSc in Analytical Science with Quality Management (WD_SANSC_R)	1 / 0 / E
INTR-0017	PG Dip in Analytical Science with Quality Management (WD_SANSC_G)	1 / 0 / E
INTR-0017	Postgraduate Programmes in Science (WD_SGRAD_XX)	5 / 0 / E

Indicative Content

- Introduction to pharmaceutical legislation: structure and role of the US, European and other regulatory authorities
- Licensing of Drug Products, legal basis for an application; licensing routes in EU-centralised, decentralised, Mutual Recognition following decentralised procedure and national applications
- Applications to US FDA
- Introduction to procedures in emerging markets: use of Certificates of Pharmaceutical Products (CPP)
- Structure of the common technical document: full and abridged applications
- Strategy for managing marketing authorisations, variations, parallel procedures, renewals and line extensions
- Harmonisation of standards in the Pharmaceutical Industry ICH Guidelines
- European Directorate for the quality of medicines (EDQM): structure and functions (TSE) certificates; Ph.Eur.; counterfeit medicines
- Falsified Medicines Directive
- Pharmacovigilance Monitoring Drug Safety Pharmacovigilance system master file (PSMF) Periodic Safety Update Report; risk benefit evaluation
- Interface between regulatory affairs and operations (Compliance files Quality agreements) GxP GLP, GMP. GDP, GCP

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Evaluate legislation and regulations governing the pharmaceutical and medical device industry to ensure compliance with regulatory requirements.
2. Compile regulatory documentation in a format for submission to authorities in EU/US/Japan (Common Technical Document) applications and maintenance.
3. Develop a strategy for submission and maintenance of marketing authorisations.
4. Interpret the roles of the various regulatory agencies including EDQM, EMA and National Competent authorities, and assess the various licencing routes in the EU.
5. Design a pharmacovigilance system in compliance with the regulations.
6. Assess the regulations and specific commitments to agencies to ensure compliance between regulatory affairs and operations.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Presentation.
- Lectures.
- Tutorials.
- Case study.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>In-Class Assessment</i>	50%	1,2,4
<i>Assignment</i>	10%	3
<i>Assignment</i>	40%	5,6

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** No understanding of the basic concepts of regulatory affairs. Unable to apply the knowledge given to an industrial environment.
- 40%-59%:** Adequate consideration of the concepts of advanced regulatory affairs. Sufficient attempt at application of theory to practice.
- 60%-69%:** Show evidence of underpinning knowledge of subject area. Some evidence of evaluation and synthesis of subject area and ability to incorporate new regulatory affairs in industrial setting.
- 70%-100%:** Excellent level of critical analysis, originality of thought and comprehensive knowledge of the subject area. Able to evaluate and synthesise relevant issues.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture		40
Tutorial		8
Independent Learning		222

Essential Material

- "European Medicines Agency." <http://www.ema.europa.eu>
- "ICH Guidelines." <http://www.ich.org>
- MHRA, M. _Good Pharmacovigilance Practice_. London: MHRA, 2014.

Supplementary Material

- "Food and drugs Administration ." www.fda.gov